



KNOWHOW?



Q I recently installed Fedora 15 on my laptop. Everything is working fine including the audio and wireless functions. But when I try playing a few of the divX files, it generates an error. I cannot even play MP3 songs in it. Can you please help me?

—Yogesh,
yogesh1018@gmail.com

A. The error is due to the lack of support for playing MP3 files. You need to install the plug-ins first. To do so, run the following command as the root user:

```
#rpm -ivh http://download1.rpmsfusion.org/free/fedora/rpmsfusion-free-release-stable.noarch.rpm
```

```
#yum install gstreamer-ffmpeg  
gstreamer-plugins-ugly gstreamer-  
plugins-bad -y
```

The first command adds the 'rpmfusion repo' and the second installs the packages. After the installation is complete, try playing your MP3 files. It should work.

Q I would like to know how 'wall' works on a Linux system. I understand it is basically used to broadcast a message to all the

logged in users. I have tried the command on my Linux system but it did not work. Kindly give me the steps to broadcast messages to all users.

—Satish Babu,
babu.s17@gmail.com

A. You have not mentioned exactly what error you receive while using *wall*. *Wall* is used to display the contents of a file or, by default, its standard input, on the terminals of all currently logged in users. It is part of the *util-linux* package, a collection of basic systems utilities and is available by default on most Linux installations. If this is not installed on your system then first install the *util-linux* package from your distro's repository and read the manual page of *wall* for more details. The reasons for an error could be that the package was not installed or the command was not used correctly. While using the standard input from a terminal, do remember to terminate the message with the EOF key (usually Control-D). Hope this, along with the details in the man pages, resolves your issue.

Q I have liked FOSS for a long time and your magazine played a big role in taking my passion for open source to the next level. My query now is related to the Squid proxy. Can you please tell me where I can find the tutorial for Squid Proxy Server? Which Linux flavour would be best if I need to set up a proxy server for a small organisation?

—Syed Mohammed Khawar,
syed.khawar@gmail.com

A. You can search the Internet for the tutorial on setting up Squid Proxy Server. There are many useful resources available on different sites. There are a few video tutorials available at YouTube.com too. You can browse the documentation section at <http://www.squid-cache.org> to get the details on installation and configuration.

There is no hard and fast rule to select Linux flavours that run Squid Proxy Server. It works well with any Linux distro. Still, I would recommend that you use any stable distro such as CentOS or Debian.

Q I use CentOS 5 on my desktop and am facing a problem while installing wvdial rpm. I have downloaded it from ftp.centos.org/5.7/os/i386/CentOS/wvdial-1.54.0-5.2.2.1.i386.rpm. I tried the following command:

```
rpm -Uivh wvdial-1.54.0-  
5.2.2.1.i386.rpm
```

...but I get the error shown below:

```
"error: can't create transaction  
lock on /var/lib/rpm/___db.000"
```

Please suggest how I could solve this issue.

—Samraj,
sankum@yahoo.co.in

A. It seems that you are trying to install the rpm as a normal user. Installing the rpm as the root should work. 